# SE(3)-WAM: Role-Aware 4D World–Action Modeling for Dynamic Manipulation

Anonymous CVPR submission

**Figure placeholder: Fig. 1 teaser — a role-aware 4D view of a moving scene (real robot)**

**Layout:** full width, two parts. **(a) Left, ∼62%:** one real-robot frame of the *linear-motion grasp* at the instant a chunk is issued. Overlays in the paper's semantic colors: blue = the target's past SE(3) poses from the causal tracker (small triads at $-350 \ldots 0$ ms, fading with age); orange = the target's SE(3) forecast at the execution times of the chunk, taken from the training-time heads evaluated offline; light orange arrows = sparse 3D flow on the context on the $14 \times 14$ grid only; purple = the commanded gripper path meeting the target at $\tau^{\mathrm{a}}$. A gray ghost marks the pose observed at capture, with a dashed red arrow showing where a reactive policy would close. A thin timeline strip under the image: capture $\tau_t \rightarrow$ latency $\ell_t \rightarrow$ execution $\tau^{\mathrm{a}}$. **(b) Right, ∼38%:** top: "Image-space WAM: future frames or latents at uniform fidelity" (filmstrip icon); middle: "SE(3)-WAM: SE(3) for the target, sparse 3D flow for the context, training only" (triads + sparse arrows); bottom **(required)**: SR vs. added latency (0–200 ms) for SE(3)-WAM and the strongest baseline (data: the latency sweep of Appendix D.2). **Rules:** real photo kept unretouched; overlays drawn from logged tracker/forecast/command data of that trial; caption states the trial's outcome.

Figure 1. **A role-aware 4D view of a moving scene.** Between image capture and the first command, a part on the conveyor moves farther than the grasp tolerates. SE(3)-WAM encodes the target's metric motion (blue) and is trained to forecast the target's SE(3) pose precisely and the whole scene coarsely as a sparse 3D flow (orange), so that its commands meet the target when they execute (purple). Image-space world–action models forecast appearance at uniform fidelity instead. Right: success against added latency on Dynamic-14.

## Abstract

*Manipulating moving objects requires actions that fit the scene when they execute, not when the image was captured, yet every millisecond spent inferring the scene's motion lets the target move further. World–action models forecast future images or latents at uniform fidelity, spending time on appearance while leaving the target's metric pose implicit; target-centric predictors are fast but ignore the surroundings that constrain the motion. We observe that the parts of a dynamic scene need different precision: the target's pose decides contact to within millimeters, whereas the rest of the scene matters only through the clearance it leaves. We present SE(3)-WAM, a world–action model built on this role-aware 4D structure. It encodes the target's motion as a metric SE(3) pose history and is trained to forecast the target's future SE(3) trajectory precisely and the whole scene coarsely as a sparse 3D flow. The forecasts serve only as training supervision and are skipped at deployment, so inference needs neither past frames nor a generated future and stays fast enough for real-time control. On Dynamic-14, a simulated benchmark in which the scene keeps moving during inference, SE(3)-WAM achieves [XX.X]% success, [XX.X] points above the strongest baseline, and succeeds in [XX]% of trials on six real-robot tasks with diverse target motion.*

## 1. Introduction

Learning-based manipulation has advanced rapidly, from diffusion policies to vision–language–action (VLA) and world–action models (WAMs) [5, 9, 20, 31, 44, 50, 65], yet most of this progress assumes that objects stay still unless the robot moves them. In factories, kitchens, and human–robot handovers, objects keep moving while the robot perceives, computes, and acts. This poses two coupled difficulties. A single image does not reveal how the target is moving, and by the time an action executes, the target is no longer where it was seen: a part on a conveyor at 0.1 m/s travels 15 mm during a 150 ms delay, more than a parallel-jaw grasp typically tolerates (Fig. 1).

Recent work equips policies with a memory of past motion and a forecast of the future [11, 27, 39, 57]. Both cost the resource that dynamic manipulation lacks most, time: richer histories and denser forecasts add computation, and the added latency enlarges the very error the forecast is meant to remove. Existing designs therefore trade information against speed. Video-based WAMs forecast whole future frames or latents at uniform fidelity [27, 44, 50], and methods that restrict prediction to dynamic regions or salient tokens still predict in image space [39, 57]. In both, most capacity goes to appearance, and the quantity that decides contact, the target's metric pose when the action executes, stays implicit. Target-centric predictors sit at the other end [11, 15, 28]: they are fast but blind to surroundings that

can block or redirect the motion. None of them provides knowledge of the moving scene that is precise where contact depends on it, coarse elsewhere, and cheap to use at execution time.

Our key observation is that a dynamic policy needs to know very little precisely. Contact depends on the target's pose at the moment the action executes, to within millimeters, whereas the rest of the scene matters only through the clearance it leaves. Nor does this knowledge have to be computed at test time: a forecast that supervises training shapes what the policy represents and can be dropped at deployment [54]. SE(3)-WAM builds on both ideas (Fig. 2). It sees the current image together with short metric SE(3) histories of the target and the robot, which convey motion directly instead of a stack of past frames. A world stream is trained to forecast, in one metric 4D space, the target's future SE(3) trajectory precisely and the whole scene coarsely as a sparse 3D flow, and an action stream reads the world stream's summary and replans as often as its latency permits. SE(3)-WAM thus gains the precision of a metric forecast at a latency close to that of a reactive policy.

We evaluate SE(3)-WAM on Dynamic-14, a simulated benchmark of fourteen tasks in which observation, scene motion, and action execution share one physical clock, so the scene keeps moving while a policy computes. SE(3)-WAM achieves state-of-the-art success of [XX.X]%, [XX.X] points above the strongest baseline, at a p95 latency of [XX] ms, and succeeds in [XX]% of trials on six real-robot tasks, against [XX]% for the strongest baseline. Four final-scale controls isolate the contributions of target-motion history, future supervision, and its two geometric components.

Our contributions are threefold:

- We propose role-aware 4D modeling for dynamic manipulation. Tracing how latency and estimation errors reach the contact shows that only the target needs millimeter precision, so we represent the target precisely by its metric SE(3) pose history and future trajectory, and the whole scene coarsely by a sparse 3D flow.
- We present SE(3)-WAM, a world–action model trained with these role-aware 4D forecasts as supervision, at a latency close to that of a reactive policy.
- We build Dynamic-14, in which the scene keeps moving during inference, and show state-of-the-art results on it and on six real-robot tasks.

## 2. Related Work

**Dynamic manipulation.** Compensating for the time between sensing and acting is a classical problem, from control with dead time [36] to catching systems that track the target with Kalman-type filters and plan an interception [1–3, 30]; such systems are precise but engineered for each object and task. Learned policies have recently been brought to moving scenes. PUMA reads historical optical flow and is supervised with future object features [11], DynamicWAM conditions a WAM on flow and kinematic descriptors and executes it with real-time chunking [27], and other methods forecast salient tokens, future images, or compact future codes and feed them to the policy at test time [28, 39, 55, 58]. Execution schemes instead reduce or hide latency, by overlapping inference with execution [32, 34, 48], keeping consecutive chunks consistent [6, 25], or conditioning on the execution time [40, 43]. They decide when actions are computed and applied, whereas SE(3)-WAM changes what the policy represents; we run every method under the same real-time executor.

**Predictive supervision in world–action models.** World–action models (WAMs) generate future video and actions in one network [23, 44, 50, 63], building on video prediction as a policy objective [16, 41, 47]. Because video is costly and dominated by appearance, recent work changes what is forecast, such as dynamic regions, depth, and semantic features [57], flow and geometry alongside RGB [53], object masks or slots [26, 51], or compact latents [21, 22], and asks whether the forecast is needed at test time: Fast-WAM retains most of the benefit of video modeling without test-time imagination [54], and PUMA and others drop their predictors after training [11, 38, 59]. SE(3)-WAM adopts this training-only use and changes the target of the supervision: instead of pixels, features, or latents at one resolution, a metric 4D state whose precision follows each entity's role in contact.

**Geometric representations of motion.** Metric 3D inputs make policies more precise and sample-efficient [12, 18, 33, 56]. Motion has been represented by 2D point tracks [4, 45, 49, 61], 3D flow [13, 17, 52, 62], and object keypoints or SE(3) trajectories [15, 29, 37, 46], and rigid-body decompositions have long been used to learn scene dynamics [7, 8]. These works describe the scene with one kind of representation, dense flow or tracks everywhere or a pose for each object; DOCIR separates the robot, the target, and obstacles, but as input encodings [10]. SE(3)-WAM assigns precision by role: a coarse sparse 3D flow describes the whole scene, and the target, on which contact depends to within millimeters, is additionally described by its SE(3) history and forecast. Appendix F discusses further related work.

## 3. SE(3)-WAM

SE(3)-WAM is a world–action model that represents a dynamic scene at role-dependent precision. As shown in Fig. 2, the current image and short metric SE(3) histories of the target and the robot form a world stream, which is trained to forecast the target's SE(3) trajectory and a sparse 3D flow

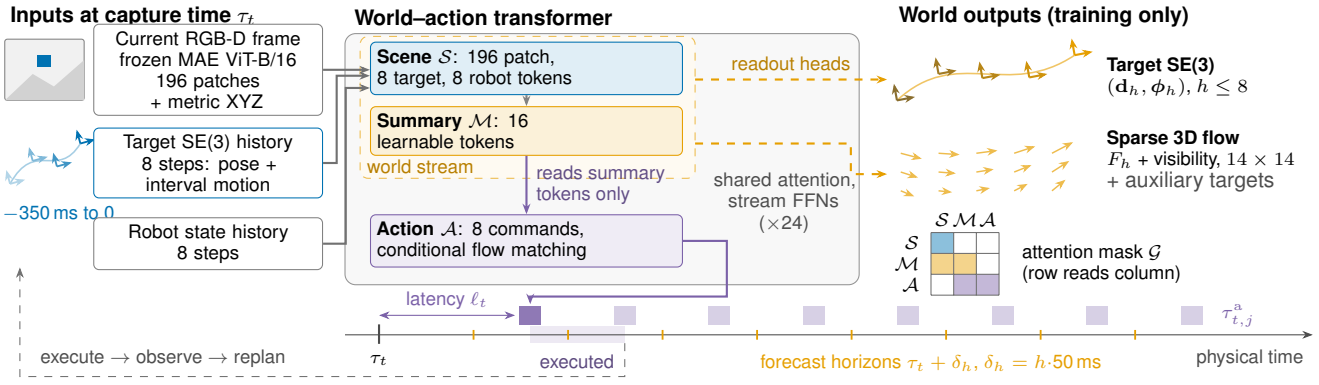



Figure 2. **SE(3)-WAM.** The world stream holds 212 scene tokens, the current image patches from a frozen encoder together with short histories of the target's metric SE(3) pose and of the robot state, and 16 summary tokens. During training, light heads read the world stream out into a role-aware 4D forecast at physical horizons $\tau_t + \delta_h$: the target's SE(3) trajectory and a sparse 3D flow with visibility on a $14 \times 14$ grid over the whole scene (dashed: training only). The action stream generates a chunk of 8 commands by flow matching. The attention mask $\mathcal{G}$ lets scene tokens read the scene, summary tokens read the scene and summaries, and actions read summaries and actions. The policy observes and replans at the first control boundary at or after each query ends.

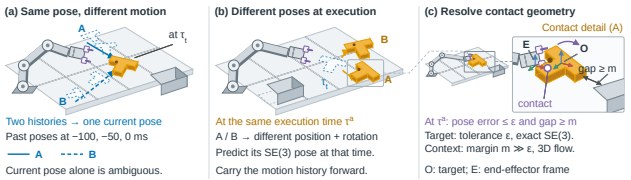



Figure 3. **Acting on a moving target** (schematic). (a) Two histories reach the same pose at capture time $\tau_t$ but imply different motions. (b) At the execution time $\tau^{\mathrm{a}}$, they lead to different target poses. (c) A contact requires the end-effector frame $E$ to match the target $O$ within $\varepsilon$, whereas the context matters only through the gap it leaves, $m \gg \varepsilon$.

of the whole scene. An action stream shares attention with the world stream and generates action chunks by conditional flow matching [24].

### 3.1. Acting at Execution Time

At query $t$, a policy receives an image, a depth map, and the robot state captured at time $\tau_t$, together with histories of earlier states, and outputs a chunk $(\mathbf{a}_{t,0}, \ldots, \mathbf{a}_{t,H-1})$ whose $j$-th command executes at

$$\tau^{\mathrm{a}}_{t,j} = \tau_t + \ell_t + j\Delta_a, \tag{1}$$

where $\ell_t$ is the latency from capture to the first execution and $\Delta_a$ is the control period. A command must fit the scene at $\tau^{\mathrm{a}}_{t,j}$ rather than at $\tau_t$ (Fig. 3), and the lead $\Delta = \tau^{\mathrm{a}}_{t,j} - \tau_t$ grows with every millisecond of inference.

**Where the error comes from.** Let a policy act, explicitly or implicitly, on an estimate of the target pose at $\tau^{\mathrm{a}}$ with position error $e$ and rotation error $\theta$. A contact point at lever arm $r$ is then off by at most $e + 2r\sin(\theta/2)$. Writing the target's motion over the lead as a constant velocity $\mathbf{v}$ plus a residual (acceleration, rolling, impacts), and the lead that the policy assumes as $\hat{\Delta}$, gives

$$e \le e_{\mathrm{loc}} + \hat{\Delta}\, e_v + \|\mathbf{v}\|\, e_\tau + e_{\mathrm{dyn}}, \tag{2}$$

with the errors $e_{\mathrm{loc}}$ of the current position, $e_v$ of the velocity, $e_\tau = |\hat{\Delta} - \Delta|$ of the timing, and $e_{\mathrm{dyn}}$ of the residual motion (Appendix E). Two observations guide our design. First, the precision that matters sits on the target: its pose and motion must be known to within millimeters, and its rotation error is amplified by the lever arm, whereas the surroundings matter through the clearance $m$ they leave, which is usually far larger than the contact tolerance $\varepsilon$. Second, latency enters twice, through the lead that multiplies every velocity error and through the motion that the residual accumulates, so information that costs inference time pays off only if it removes more error than the added latency creates.

### 3.2. Model

**Inputs.** SE(3)-WAM sees one image. A frozen MAE ViT-B/16 [14] encodes the current RGB frame into 196 patch tokens, and the depth map gives each patch the metric 3D position of its center point in the robot base frame. Motion comes from two short histories over the last 8 control steps (350 ms at 20 Hz). The target history consists of the current target pose in the base frame and the seven interval motions between consecutive samples, each with its translation, relative rotation, time interval, and finite-difference velocity and acceleration in physical units (Appendix A.1). The robot history consists of 8 end-effector states. Together with the patch tokens, they form 212 scene tokens. In simulation, the target pose comes from the simulator; on the real robot,

a causal tracker estimates it from the RGB-D stream (Appendix C). The model receives no past images, so the cost of visual encoding does not grow with the history.

**World and action streams.** The world stream holds the scene tokens and 16 learnable summary tokens. The action stream holds 8 tokens, one per command, each embedding a noisy command; a chunk spans 8 control periods of $\Delta_a = 50$ ms, and each command is an end-effector translation and rotation plus a gripper command. The attention mask $\mathcal{G}$ lets scene tokens attend to the scene, summary tokens to the scene and the summaries, and action tokens to the summaries and the actions. In every layer, both streams share the attention projections and have separate feed-forward networks; world tokens use layer normalization, and action tokens use adaptive layer normalization conditioned on the flow time.

### 3.3. Role-Aware 4D Supervision

The forecast heads supervise the world stream at fixed physical times $\tau_t + \delta_h$, with $\delta_h = h{\cdot}50$ ms and $h = 1, \dots, 8$, from 50 ms to 400 ms after capture. All motion labels are cumulative from the current state, and every loss averages over valid labels only.

**Target SE(3) trajectory.** For each horizon, the target's motion is

$$\mathbf{d}_h = \mathbf{p}(\tau_t{+}\delta_h) - \mathbf{p}(\tau_t), \quad \boldsymbol{\phi}_h = \mathrm{Log}\big(R(\tau_t{+}\delta_h)R(\tau_t)^\top\big)^\vee, \tag{3}$$

where $(R, \mathbf{p})$ is its pose in the base frame. A linear pose head on the mean of the final summary tokens predicts $(\hat{\mathbf{d}}_h, \hat{\boldsymbol{\phi}}_h)$, and

$$\mathcal{L}_P = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{V}|} \sum_{h \in \mathcal{V}} \Big[ \|\hat{\mathbf{d}}_h - \mathbf{d}_h\|^2 + \lambda_R \, d_{\mathrm{SO}(3)}\big(\hat{R}_h, R_h\big)^2 \Big], \tag{4}$$

where $\hat{R}_h = \mathrm{Exp}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\phi}}_h^\wedge) R(\tau_t)$ and $\mathcal{V}$ is the set of valid horizons.

**Sparse 3D flow of the whole scene.** The center points of the 196 patches on the $14 \times 14$ grid cover the target, the robot, and the surroundings. For each point $i$ and horizon $h$, a linear head on its final patch token predicts the base-frame displacement $\hat{F}_{ih} \in \mathbb{R}^3$ and a visibility logit $\hat{o}_{ih}$, and

$$\mathcal{L}_F = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{V}_F|} \sum_{(i,h) \in \mathcal{V}_F} \Big[ \tfrac{1}{3} \big\| (\hat{F}_{ih} - F_{ih})/s \big\|^2 + \mathrm{BCE}(\hat{o}_{ih}, o_{ih}) \Big], \tag{5}$$

with a fixed scale $s$ fitted on the training labels, the visibility $o_{ih}$, and the set $\mathcal{V}_F$ of valid labels. The grid is coarse, about [X] mm between points in the workspace. The flow thus gives every part of the scene a coarse motion estimate, and the target additionally receives the precise SE(3) supervision of Eq. (4); this is how SE(3)-WAM allocates precision by role.

**Auxiliary targets.** Two further targets regularize the representation. Future appearance heads on the patch tokens predict, at every horizon, the metric depth, the features of a frozen DINOv3 teacher [35], and the RGB of moving surfaces. A small head on the summary tokens reconstructs the RGB of the current target region, which ties the summaries to the target without any future label. Their losses form $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{aux}}$ (Appendix A.2).

### 3.4. Training and Inference

**Training.** For a normalized chunk $\mathbf{a}_1$, noise $\mathbf{a}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I)$, and flow time $u \sim \mathcal{U}[0, 1]$, the action stream regresses the velocity

$$\mathcal{L}_A = \mathbb{E} \left\| v_\psi(\mathbf{a}_u, u \mid \mathcal{S}_t, \mathcal{G}) - (\mathbf{a}_1 - \mathbf{a}_0) \right\|^2, \tag{6}$$

with $\mathbf{a}_u = (1-u)\mathbf{a}_0 + u\mathbf{a}_1$, the scene tokens $\mathcal{S}_t$ of query $t$, and the error averaged over valid commands. All parts are trained jointly with

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{L}_A + \lambda_P \mathcal{L}_P + \lambda_F \mathcal{L}_F + \lambda_{\mathrm{aux}} \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{aux}}. \tag{7}$$

**Inference.** As in recent WAMs [23, 54], the forecast heads are trained jointly and skipped at test time. Because world tokens never attend to actions, the world stream runs once per query, and the action stream integrates 5 Euler steps on its cached keys and values. A new chunk starts at the first control-period boundary after its query ends, where the policy observes again and starts the next query; until then, the executor continues the previous chunk. The policy thus replans as often as its latency allows, before every command when a query fits in one control period (Appendix A.6).

## 4. Experiments

We compare SE(3)-WAM with reactive, dynamic, and world–action policies in simulation (Sec. 4.2) and on a real robot (Sec. 4.3), and then ablate its target history and its geometric supervision (Sec. 4.4).

### 4.1. Setup

**Dynamic-14.** We built fourteen tasks in MuJoCo/robosuite [42, 64] in five families: grasping a moving target (harmonic, conveyor, translating, rotating, and occluded motion), placing into a moving receptacle, passing a wand along a rotating wire, capturing rolling or sliding objects, and grasping after an impact (Appendix B, Fig. S2). Experts with privileged simulator state provide 800 demonstrations per task. We

select configurations on development scenes and report all Dynamic-14 results on 1,400 held-out scenes (100 per task, new seeds). Our variants average three training seeds, and each baseline is trained once. We give paired 95% intervals from a bootstrap over held-out scenes.

**Protocol.** Observation, scene motion, and execution share one physical clock with a control period of 50 ms, and physics advances during inference by a latency drawn from each method's measured latency on one RTX 5090. All methods run under the same executor: a query starts at a control-period boundary, its chunk replaces the remainder of the previous chunk at the first boundary after the query ends, and the next query starts there (Appendix B.3). The +150 ms setting adds 150 ms of delay for every method, and the paused setting stops physics during inference. We report the task-balanced success rate (SR), the position error at first contact $e_p$, and the p95 time-to-action.

**Baselines.** We compare with reactive policies (ACT [60], Diffusion Policy [9], and $\pi_{0.5}$ [31]), dynamic VLAs (DynamicVLA [48] and PUMA [11]), image- or latent-space WAMs (DreamVLA [57] and OpenWAM-$\alpha$ [44]), and a dynamic WAM (DynamicWAM [27]). Each baseline uses its official code, inputs, and recipe, is trained on the same demonstrations, and receives a rendered wrist camera if its recipe uses one (Appendix B.4). SE(3)-WAM uses only the agent view, together with depth and the target pose. To give baselines the same target-motion information, $\pi_{0.5}$ and DynamicWAM also run with our SE(3) history tokens (+SE(3)). The *CV input* variant is SE(3)-WAM without forecast losses that instead receives the constant-velocity extrapolation of the target pose as input tokens.

**Implementation.** The transformer has 24 layers of width 1024 with 16 heads and 523.8M trainable parameters; the MAE ViT-B/16 encoder and the DINOv3 teacher stay frozen. On Dynamic-14, we train from a randomly initialized transformer on all windows of the demonstrations for 20 epochs (51,740 updates at a global batch size of 512) with AdamW, a cosine schedule, $\lambda_P = \lambda_F = 1$, and $\lambda_R = \lambda_{\text{aux}} = 0.1$, which takes [X] hours per seed on [N] RTX PRO 6000 GPUs (Appendix A.4). For the real robot, we pretrain a 48-layer base (1.02B parameters) on DROID [19], whose demonstrations carry no target poses: it learns the actions, the sparse 3D flow from the point tracks that PointWorld released [17], and the future DINOv3 features, for 21,060 updates on 64 GPUs. Fine-tuning on each task adds the target-state tokens and the pose head (Appendix A.5).

### 4.2. Simulation Results

SE(3)-WAM reaches [XX.X]% SR on held-out Dynamic-14 scenes (Table 1), [X.X] points above the strongest baseline, [name of the strongest baseline], and [X.X] points above the strongest baseline that receives the same SE(3) history, [name]. The margin is largest on [rotating targets and on fast conveyor and translating targets], where the target moves farthest during the lead, and its position error at first contact is [X.X] mm against [X.X] mm for [name]. Its p95 time-to-action of [XX] ms is [X]× lower than that of the image-space WAMs, whose latency adds to the lead they must bridge. With 150 ms of added delay, SE(3)-WAM keeps [XX.X]%, whereas reactive policies drop to [XX.X]% and image-space WAMs to [XX.X]%. With physics paused during inference, the difference to [name of the strongest paused baseline] is [±X.X] points, which separates the contribution of speed from that of the representation. The CV-input variant, which extrapolates the target's current motion instead of learning a forecast, trails SE(3)-WAM by [X.X] points.

**DOMINO.** On a second benchmark, we compare SE(3)-WAM with $\pi_{0.5}$, DynamicWAM, and PUMA on 24 single-arm Franka tasks of DOMINO [11], with its demonstrations and native evaluator. SE(3)-WAM reaches [XX.X]% SR against [XX.X]% for [the strongest baseline] (Appendix D.3). As on Dynamic-14, it reads the simulator pose of the target.

### 4.3. Real-Robot Experiments

We evaluate six tasks on a Franka arm ([model]) with [gripper model] and a fixed RealSense D435 RGB-D camera (Fig. S3, Table S8), comparing SE(3)-WAM with $\pi_{0.5}$, DynamicWAM, and Diffusion Policy [9]: conveyor grasping (T1), placement into a receptacle on the conveyor (T2), turntable grasping (T3), grasping a moving toy car (T4), intercepting a ball after a collision (T5), and intercepting an object that rolls or slides down a ramp (T6). Together they cover linear, circular, free planar, post-impact, and gravity-accelerated target motion. Each method is trained or fine-tuned per task on the same 100 teleoperated demonstrations, with 20 separate validation demonstrations, and runs 20 trials per task with shared trial keys. SE(3)-WAM tracks the target with [tracker] and runs on one RTX 5090 with a p95 time-to-action of [XX] ms. It succeeds in [XX.X]% of all trials, against [XX.X]% for [the strongest baseline] (Table 2). [Where its advantage is largest, and its dominant failure mode] (Fig. 4).

### 4.4. Ablations

Four controls each change one component of the final model and keep the data, recipe, and training budget, with three training seeds each (Table 3, Fig. 5). We evaluate them under the real-time protocol at 0 and 150 ms of added delay.

**Target history.** The no-history control keeps the current image, the current target pose, and the robot history, and

Table 1. **Main results.** Held-out SR (%) on Dynamic-14 (1,400 new scenes, task-balanced, real time, three training seeds for our variants and one for baselines) by family, with 150 ms of added delay, and with physics paused during inference, together with the position error at first contact $e_p$ (mm) and the p95 time-to-action on one RTX 5090. Inputs: R, RGB and robot state. D, depth. P, target SE(3) history. Best in bold. Intervals in Appendix D.

| | | Dynamic-14 SR, real time unless noted | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Method | Inputs | All | Grasp | Place | Pass | Capture | Impact | +150 ms | Paused | $e_p$ | p95 (ms) |
| ACT [60] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| Diffusion Policy [9] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| $\pi_{0.5}$ [31] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| $\pi_{0.5}$ + SE(3) | R+P | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| DynamicVLA [48] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| PUMA [11] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| DreamVLA [57] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| OpenWAM-$\alpha$ [44] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| DynamicWAM [27] | R | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| DynamicWAM + SE(3) | R+P | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| SE(3)-WAM, CV input | RD+P | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| SE(3)-WAM | RD+P | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |

Table 2. **Real-robot results.** Success rate (%) on six tasks: T1 conveyor grasping, T2 moving-receptacle placement, T3 turntable grasping, T4 moving-car grasping, T5 post-collision interception, and T6 ramp interception (20 trials per task and method). All pools the trials; intervals in Appendix C.

| Method | T1 | T2 | T3 | T4 | T5 | T6 | All |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\pi_{0.5}$ | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| DynamicWAM | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| Diffusion Policy | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |
| SE(3)-WAM | — | — | — | — | — | — | — |

**Figure placeholder: Fig. 4 — real-robot trials**

**Rows:** a success of SE(3)-WAM; the strongest baseline on the same trial key; a failure of SE(3)-WAM. **Columns:** the query frame, the first execution time $\tau^a$, and contact. **Overlays:** blue tracked past poses; purple commanded gripper path. Real photos, unretouched; overlays from logged data of each trial.

Figure 4. **Real-robot trials** of SE(3)-WAM and [the strongest baseline] on the same trial key (top two rows) and a failure of SE(3)-WAM (bottom). [One-sentence description of the selected trials.]

removes the past target poses with their velocity and acceleration features. Without them, SR changes by [signed X.X] points at 0 ms and [signed X.X] points at 150 ms of added delay (Fig. 5a). Under synthetic pose noise, SE(3)-WAM keeps [XX.X]% SR (Appendix D.4).

Table 3. **Core ablations** of the final 24-layer model on held-out Dynamic-14 scenes (three training seeds). Each row changes one component of SE(3)-WAM ($^\star$). SR, $\text{SR}_{150}$: success (%) without and with 150 ms of added delay. $e_p$: position error at first contact (mm). p95: time-to-action (ms).

| Variant | SR | $\text{SR}_{150}$ | $e_p$ | p95 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SE(3)-WAM $^\star$ | — | — | — | — |
| No target history | — | — | — | — |
| No future supervision | — | — | — | — |
| No scene-flow supervision | — | — | — | — |
| No dedicated SE(3) | — | — | — | — |

**Future supervision.** The no-future control removes all forecast losses, the SE(3), scene-flow, and future appearance targets, and keeps the current-target RGB reconstruction. It changes SR by [signed X.X] points at 0 ms and [signed X.X] points at 150 ms, which measures the effect of future supervision as a whole.

**The two geometric components.** The other two controls keep all auxiliary targets. Removing the scene-flow supervision changes SR by [signed X.X] points; since the flow covers the whole scene, this measures coarse scene motion as a whole rather than the surroundings alone. Removing the dedicated SE(3) supervision leaves the target with only the coarse flow that every part of the scene receives and changes SR by [signed X.X] points, most on [task families]. Fig. 6 shows what the SE(3) head predicts at the execution time.

**Figure placeholder: Fig. 5 — ablations (two panels)**

**(a) By task family.** SR difference to the full model of each of the four controls, per task family, at 0 and 150 ms added delay. **(b) Success and latency.** p95 time-to-action vs. SR for the full model and the four controls, at 0 and 150 ms added delay. All panels reuse the same held-out scenes and three training seeds; show paired 95% bootstrap intervals.

Figure 5. **Ablations.** (a) Effect of each control per task family. (b) Success and latency of the full model and the controls under the real-time protocol. [Summarize the measured effects.]

**Figure placeholder: Fig. 6 — forecasts at the execution time**

**Rows:** a rolling capture (median forecast error) and a post-impact grasp. **Columns:** the query frame at $\tau_t$, the frame at $\tau^{\mathrm{a}}$, and a 3D inset in the base frame. **Overlays:** blue past poses, orange forecast triads and coarse flow arrows from the training-time heads, gray ground truth at the same times, purple commanded path. Full set in Fig. S5.

Figure 6. **Forecasts at the execution time** on held-out Dynamic-14 episodes, read from the training-time heads. Top: the SE(3) forecast follows a rolling target that constant-velocity extrapolation overshoots. Bottom: before an impact, the regressed forecast lies between the possible outcomes.

## 5. Conclusion

We presented SE(3)-WAM, a world–action model for manipulating moving objects that spends precision where contact depends on it and time only where it pays off. It remembers the target's metric SE(3) motion instead of past frames, learns to forecast the target's SE(3) trajectory precisely and the whole scene coarsely as a sparse 3D flow, and lets its actions read a representation shaped by these forecasts without generating them at test time. On Dynamic-14, where the scene keeps moving while a policy computes, and on six real-robot tasks, it improves on reactive, dynamic, and world–action policies. Four final-scale controls examine the metric motion history, future supervision, and its two geometric components. [State the supported component-level conclusions after the core ablations.]

**Limitations.** SE(3)-WAM assumes a rigid target that moves on its own until contact, so deformable or articulated targets and post-contact dynamics are outside its scope. It depends on a pose estimate of the target, and tracker failures propagate to the policy; in simulation we read the pose from the simulator. The regressed target forecast cannot represent multimodal futures, e.g., before an impact. Our real-robot base learns from DROID without target poses, so its pose-related parts are learned only during fine-tuning. Finally, our tasks have a single target and slow context motion.

## LLM Usage Statement

[To be completed before submission: actual tools used, affected parts of the research and manuscript, and extent of use.]

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